

CONTENT IDEATION

Repeatable Outliers

You list the channels in your niche. Five small steps later you know which of their breakout topics have worked for many different channels, not just one. This guide walks through every step with a real example.

THE IDEA

One hit is a story. Fifteen hits are a pattern.

Every niche has videos that blew up. Copying one rarely works, because a video's views have four causes and only one of them is the topic.

$$\text{views} \approx \text{channel} \times \text{topic} \times \text{packaging} \times \text{luck}$$

This pipeline starts from the breakout videos of the channels you list, works out the topic underlying each one, and then asks YouTube whether that topic has worked for many other channels too. A real result, from 25 AI and tech channels:

TOPIC	BEST PHRASING	REPEATABILITY	CHANNELS	VERDICT
GPT-6 Astra	gpt 6 astra game	5.25	15	repeatable
AI agents	ai agents full course	3.50	17	repeatable
AI industry opportunities	ai opportunities	3.14	16	repeatable
Claude Code tutorial	claude code tutorial	2.77	10	repeatable
PDF compression	compress pdf file size free	1.67	8	not repeatable
AI password manager	ai password manager	0.55	4	not repeatable

Six of the eight topics of the run. A topic is judged by its best phrasing.

THE PRINCIPLE BEHIND IT

One viral video proves little. The same topic working for 17 channels proves a lot.

Packaging and luck differ from channel to channel. When many unrelated channels all beat their own normal with the same topic, the thing they share is the topic.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Packaging Title, thumbnail and hook: how a video is sold, as opposed to what it is about.

Channels How many different channels had a hit with the topic.

Score THE REPEATABILITY COLUMN Each hit adds between 0 and 1: more when recent and from a channel your size. The score is the total.

Five steps. Each one asks one question.

Every step takes the previous step's answer, does one small thing, and saves what went in and what came out. The colour tells you where the answer comes from.

1	YouTube	Find outliers	Which videos far outperformed their own channel?
2	LLM	Outliers to topics	Which topics are those videos about?
3	YouTube	Search terms	What do viewers really type to find them? (a: YouTube, b: LLM)
4	YouTube	Similar outliers	Has each search query worked for many other channels?
5	Rule	Scoreboard	Which topics are repeatable, and which scores highest?

The same run, as a funnel



Real numbers from the run on the previous page.

WHAT IT ANSWERS

These five steps answer one question: is the topic **repeatable**, has it worked for many different channels? Whether more people are searching for it than last year is a separate question, answered with Google search data. This pipeline costs nothing but YouTube quota.

THREE KINDS OF STEP

YouTube steps fetch facts. **Rule** steps are plain arithmetic. **LLM** steps use an AI model only to translate between how people talk: a video title, a YouTube search. The numbers never come from the model.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Outlier A video from one of your listed channels with at least 7 times that channel's normal views: an outlier multiple of 7.

Search query The words a viewer types into YouTube's search box. Also called a search term.

LLM A large language model: an AI that reads and writes text, like ChatGPT or Claude.

Quota YouTube's daily allowance: 10,000 units. One search costs 100.

Which videos far outperformed their own channel?

For each channel on your list, the pipeline finds the channel's normal: the median views of its last 50 uploads. A video at 7 times that normal is an outlier: an outlier multiple of 7. The higher the multiple, the fewer you find. The 10 biggest go on.

GOES IN

@PavanLalwani

@nicksaraev

@SiliconValleyGirl

@mreflow

and **21** more channels from config.py.

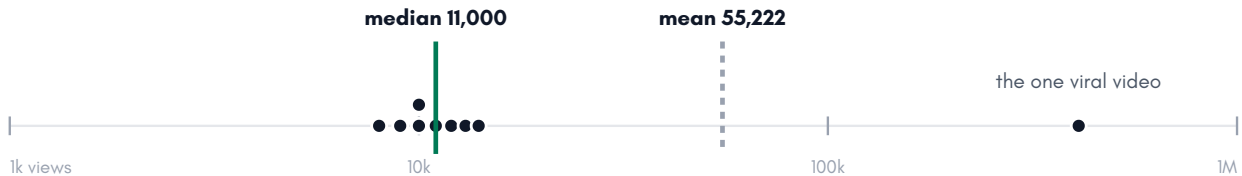
COMES OUT

"Convert Image PDF to Editable Text" **6.1M** vs **28,152** normal = **216x**

"CLAUDE CODE FULL COURSE 4 HOURS" **2.5M** vs **79,991** = **31.6x**

"Build Your First AI Agent in 10 Minutes" **347,736** vs **14,976** = **23.2x**

10 outlier videos.



Nine uploads of an imaginary channel. The average says 54,000 views is normal. The median says 11,000, the truth.

WHY IT WORKS

Compare a channel with itself.

Raw views mostly measure how big the channel is. A channel's own normal cancels that out. The normal is the median, not the average, because one viral video drags an average far too high.

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

- It can only find topics the channels on your list have made. The list is the most important setting.
- One outlier is one data point. It may be luck or a great thumbnail. That is why steps 3 and 4 exist.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Channel's normal The median views of its last 50 uploads: half got more, half got less.

Outlier A video from one of your listed channels with at least 7 times that channel's normal views: an outlier multiple of 7.

TRY IT `uv run python -m steps.find_outliers @Fireship`

SAVED AS `01_find_outliers.json`

Which topics are those videos about?

An AI model reads each outlier's title and the first lines of its description, and names the topic underneath, with the plain search query a viewer would type. Videos about the same thing become one topic.

GOES IN

"GPT-6 Astra Is Finally Here (And It's REALLY Good)"

description: Here's my first look at GPT-6-Astra after spending some time using it myself ...

"I Tested GPT 6 Astra vs Fable 5.1 (No Hype ...)"

"CLAUDE CODE FULL COURSE 4 HOURS: Build & Sell"

and 7 more outlier videos, each with its description.

COMES OUT

GPT-6 Astra · 2 videos "gpt 6 astra"

Claude Code tutorial · 1 "claude
video code"

PDF compression · 1 video "compress pdf"

→ 8 topics, each with a search query.

WHY IT WORKS

A title is packaging. The topic is what is underneath.

"Is Finally Here (And It's REALLY Good)" is how one creator sold the video. The description is where creators usually say plainly what a video covers. Reading through the packaging is a language task, so it goes to a language model.

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

- Many descriptions open with sponsor links and say nothing about the video. Then the title is all the model has.
- The search query is the model's guess. It can be too specific for what people really type. Step 3 corrects for that.
- A different model may split or merge topics differently.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Topic What a video is about. One topic covers many keywords and wordings.

Search query The words a viewer types into YouTube's search box. Also called a search term.

TRY IT `uv run python -m steps.outliers_to_topics` (one small LLM call)

SAVED AS 02_outliers_to_topics.json

What does YouTube's search box suggest?

Type something into YouTube and it finishes your sentence. Those suggestions are the search terms viewers really type, most popular first. The pipeline asks for them, for every topic's query. It is free and needs no key.

GOES IN

claude code

One topic's search query.



COMES OUT

claude code tutorial

claude code for beginners

claude code skills

claude code vs cursor

claude code agents

and 4 more suggestions.

WHY IT WORKS

Ask the crowd how they phrase it.

A model guessed the query in step 2. YouTube's search box knows what millions of viewers actually typed. Real phrasings beat guessed ones, because the search results, and so the evidence, depend on the exact words.

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

- It gives an order, not numbers. You learn what is popular, not how popular.
- Long, specific queries get few suggestions or none. Short queries work best.
- It is an unofficial address that YouTube could change without notice. If it fails, the pipeline goes on with the topic's own query.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Suggestions What YouTube's search box offers while you type (autocomplete).

Search query FROM STEP 2 The words a viewer types into YouTube's search box. Also called a search term.

TRY IT `uv run python -m steps.youtube_suggestions "claude code"`

SAVED AS `03_a_youtube_suggestions.json`

Which phrasings are worth a search of their own?

An AI model says keep or drop for each suggestion: same language, still on topic, a different angle or audience. Then YouTube's own order decides: the 3 most popular of the kept ones go on. Each is scored in the next step as an idea of its own.

GOES IN

claude code	+ 9 suggestions
gpt 6 astra	+ 9 suggestions
ai agents	+ 9 suggestions

8 topics with their suggestions.



COMES OUT

claude code	the topic's own query
claude code tutorial	kept · YouTube's #1
claude code for beginners	kept · #2
claude code skills	kept · #3

29 search queries for the 8 topics.

WHY IT WORKS

The same topic can win under one phrasing and lose under another.

"Tutorial" and "skills" are different audiences, with different videos competing. In this run the first scored 2.77 and the second 1.70. The guardrail: a pick that is not in YouTube's list is thrown away, so the model cannot invent a query.

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

- Every extra query costs a YouTube search: 29 searches are 2,900 of your 10,000 daily units.
- "A different angle" is a judgement. And popularity is YouTube's, so expect an odd one now and then: "gpt 6 astra roblox" is its #1 suggestion. Odd for an AI channel, yet it went on to hit on 12 channels.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Phrasing One way of wording a topic, such as "claude code for beginners".

Quota YouTube's daily allowance: 10,000 units. One search costs 100.

Guardrail A check on the AI model: it may only pick from the real list it was given.

TRY IT `uv run python -m steps.query_variants "claude code"`

SAVED AS `03_b_query_variants.json`

Has each search query worked for many other channels?

One YouTube search per query. Every result from **another channel**, not yours and not one you listed, is compared with what its own channel normally gets. A video at 5 times its channel's normal is a hit: an outlier on someone else's channel. Every hit adds to the query's score, and newer hits, and hits from channels near your size, add more.

GOES IN

claude code tutorial

gpt 6 astra game

ai agents full course

pdf ocr in python

and **25** more search queries. One YouTube search each.



COMES OUT

gpt 6 astra game 16 hits · 15 channels · **5.25**

ai agents full course 21 hits · 17 channels · **3.50**

claude code tutorial 14 hits · 10 channels · **2.77**

pdf ocr in python 7 hits · 7 channels · **0.85**

The last number on each line is the query's score.

The next page works through one of these scores by hand.

WHY IT WORKS

Divide by the channel, then demand many channels.

A video's views come from the channel, the topic, the packaging and luck. Dividing by what the channel normally gets cancels the channel. Asking for hits on many unrelated channels cancels packaging and luck, because those differ from channel to channel. What is left is the topic.

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

- It only sees the videos YouTube's search returns. Most flops on the topic stay invisible.
- The bars (5 times normal, 8 channels, the score) are judgement calls. You can change them.
- It measures the topic, not you. A repeatable topic still needs a good title, thumbnail and video.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Channel's normal The median views of its last 50 uploads: half got more, half got less.

Hit A video on another channel with at least 5 times its own channel's normal views: an outlier on someone else's channel.

Score Each hit adds between 0 and 1: more when recent and from a channel your size. The score is the total.

Repeatable Hits on 8 or more other channels, and a score of 2.0 or more.

TRY IT `uv run python -m steps.score_repeatability "claude code"`

SAVED AS `04_score_repeatability.json`

How "claude code tutorial" got its score of 2.77.

1 Search, and set aside what can't be compared

YouTube returns up to 50 videos for the query. Videos from your own channel or a listed one, older than 2 years, or with under 1,000 views, are set aside.

2 Is each video a hit? $\text{views} \div \text{its channel's normal} \geq 5$

VIDEO	VIEWS	CHANNEL'S NORMAL	RESULT
"Claude Code Complete Course (Telugu)" · codewithkg	151,848	973	156x hit
"The Ultimate Beginner's Guide ..." · Metics Media	953,455	14,534	65.6x hit
"FULL Claude Code Tutorial For Beginners ..." · AI Foundations	137,186	18,314	7.5x hit

This search found 14 hits, on 10 different channels. A video at 3 times normal adds nothing.

3 How much does each hit count? $\text{freshness} \times \text{closeness}$

Freshness halves every 180 days: today 1.0, six months 0.5, a year 0.25. **Closeness** is 1.0 for a channel your size, 0.5 for one 10 times bigger or smaller, 0.33 for 100 times, 0.25 for 1,000 times. Size is the channel's normal. In this run yours is about 140 views.

HIT	AGE → FRESHNESS	CHANNEL SIZE → CLOSNESS	COUNTS FOR
codewithkg	82 days → 0.73	6.8 times yours → 0.55	$0.73 \times 0.55 = 0.40$
Productive Dude	162 days → 0.54	5.4 times yours → 0.58	$0.54 \times 0.58 = 0.31$
Metics Media	43 days → 0.85	102 times yours → 0.33	$0.85 \times 0.33 = 0.28$

Productive Dude's hit was 1,302 times its normal and counts for less than codewithkg's 156x. How big a hit was does not matter. How recent it is, and how much the channel is like yours, does.

4 Add up all 14 hits

$$0.40 + 0.31 + 0.28 + 0.25 + 10 \text{ smaller ones} = 2.77$$

5 The verdict: two tests, both must pass

SEARCH QUERY	OTHER CHANNELS WITH A HIT (8 OR MORE)	SCORE (2.0 OR MORE)	VERDICT
claude code tutorial	10 pass	2.77 pass	repeatable
gpt 6 astra	6 fail	2.37 pass	not repeatable

6 A topic is judged by its best phrasing

The topic Claude Code tutorial was searched four ways: "claude code tutorial" 2.77, "claude code" 2.67, "for beginners" 2.56, "skills" 1.70. The topic takes the best one, 2.77, and that phrasing is the one to build your title around.

Which topics are repeatable?

The last step puts one row per topic on a scoreboard: the best phrasing, its score and its channels, and the verdict. Repeatable topics are ranked by score, highest first.

GOES IN

The topics and their YouTube scores.



COMES OUT

GPT-6 Astra

repeatable

AI agents

repeatable

Claude Code tutorial

repeatable

PDF compression

not repeatable

6 of 8 topics are repeatable.

WHY IT WORKS

A topic is judged by its best phrasing.

Claude Code tutorial was searched four ways. "Claude code tutorial" scored 2.77 and "claude code skills" 1.70. The topic takes the best, and that phrasing is the one to build your title around. PDF compression had hits on 8 channels, enough, but a score of 1.67, so it fails the second test.

WHERE IT FALLS SHORT

- "Repeatable" means the topic has worked for many channels. It does not say whether the audience is growing. That takes search data.
- The data moves. Run it again before you commit weeks to a topic.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Verdict The pipeline's conclusion for a topic. It always comes with its reason.

Repeatable FROM STEP 4 Hits on 8 or more other channels, and a score of 2.0 or more.

Phrasing FROM STEP 3B One way of wording a topic, such as "claude code for beginners".

TRY IT `uv run python -m steps.scoreboard` (needs no keys)

SAVED AS 05_scoreboard.json and scoreboard.csv

What this pipeline can't tell you.

It turns other channels' results into evidence about topics. It is not an oracle. Knowing where it is weak is what lets you trust it where it is strong.

LIMIT	WHAT TO DO ABOUT IT
It only sees the channels you list	A topic none of them has made stays invisible. List the channels of your niche, including small ones, and refresh the list now and then.
You only see the winners	YouTube shows the videos that did well. The many that flopped on the same topic are mostly hidden. Asking for hits on 8 or more channels reduces this. It does not remove it.
It says nothing about demand	Repeatable means it worked for others. Whether more people want it than last year is a separate question, answered with Google search data.
It costs quota	Every search query costs 100 of your 10,000 daily YouTube units. This run's 29 searches cost 2,900. Answers are kept for 24 hours, so running again the same day is free.
The thresholds are opinions	7 times normal, 5 times normal, 8 channels, 180 days. They are all named settings in config.py. Change one, run again, and see which verdicts move.

FIRST PRINCIPLE

A model you can't inspect, you can't improve.

Every step saves a file with a summary, what went in and what came out. When a verdict surprises you, open the run folder and walk back, file by file, to the step that caused it.

WORDS ON THIS PAGE

Quota YouTube's daily allowance: 10,000 units. One search costs 100.

Cache Answers from YouTube and the AI model are stored for 24 hours, so running again the same day is free.

config.py The settings file. Every number in this guide is a named setting in it.

RUN IT YOURSELF

One command.

Set it up once and list the channels of your niche. A page opens in your browser that shows every step of the run.

<code>cp .env.example .env</code>	your YouTube and LLM keys
<code>cp config.py.example config.py</code>	your channel, and the channels to scan
<code>uv run pipeline_youtube_repeatable_outliers.py</code>	run it

No Google Ads access needed.